

SANKOFA CONSULTING LIMITED

Website Design and Build Brief

with Full Website Content

Board Governance Advisory, Training and Consultancy

Prepared by Alvas Onguru and Duncan Watta, Nairobi

For review by Shibeshi Bettemariam, Addis Ababa

25 September 2026

CONFIDENTIAL WORKING DRAFT

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PART A: DESIGN AND BUILD BRIEF

1. Project Overview

Sankofa Consulting Limited needs a professional, bilingual website to launch in November 2026. The site is Sankofa's shop window. Every prospect who receives a letter, an invitation or a referral will look us up, so the website must make a new firm look like an established governance institution from the first screen.

Sankofa is a board governance advisory, training and consultancy firm formed by partners in Nairobi and Addis Ababa. It helps Ethiopia build the boards, codes and institutions its corporations need as they move from state to listed ownership. The name comes from the Akan concept of Sankofa, meaning "go back and get it": retrieving the wisdom of the past to build a better future.

2. Objectives

- **Prove credibility.** Present Sankofa as a serious, established governance advisor to chairs, directors and institutional leaders.
- **Explain the offer clearly.** Show the five service lines and five training programmes in a way a busy director understands in seconds.
- **Drive registrations.** Let visitors register for training events online, easily and securely.
- **Generate enquiries.** Turn interest in board consultancy and advisory into direct conversations.
- **Build a relationship over time.** Capture newsletter subscribers and expressions of interest in the directors membership body.
- **Show thought leadership.** Publish governance insights that keep Sankofa visible between events.

3. Target Audiences

Audience	What they need from the site
Institutional leaders: Securities Exchange, regulator, SOE ministry, Ethiopian Investment Holdings	Confidence that Sankofa has the experience to help set national governance standards
Board chairs and directors of listed companies and SOEs	A clear picture of how Sankofa can help their board, and who the partners are
Company secretaries, CEOs and HR directors	Programme details, dates, prices and a simple way to register colleagues
Individual directors	Programmes for their own development and information on the directors body
Referrers and partners	Material they can share with confidence

4. Site Map

Page	Purpose	Key features
Home	First impression; route visitors to what they need	Hero statement, services overview, upcoming events, partner credentials, newsletter signup
About	Build trust in the firm and the	Meaning of Sankofa, partner profiles, the

Page	Purpose	Key features
	people	Kenya and Ethiopia partnership, values
Services	Explain what Sankofa does	Five service lines, each with its own section or sub page and an enquiry prompt
Programmes and Events	Sell training	Five programme pages, event calendar, downloadable brochures, online registration
Insights	Thought leadership	Articles and briefing papers, filterable by topic, with download and share
Directors Body	Build support for Ethiopia's directors membership body	Explanation, founding principles, expression of interest form
Contact	Make contact easy	Addis Ababa and Nairobi contacts, enquiry form, map

Global elements on every page: header with logo, main navigation and a language switch for English and Amharic; a prominent "Register for a programme" button; and a footer with contacts, including +254 720 304 147, newsletter signup, LinkedIn link, privacy notice and copyright.

5. Design Direction

The website must apply the Sankofa visual identity now in development. It should feel like a fine annual report or a respected private bank: calm, assured and precise. African roots should come through in craft, proportion and the Sankofa symbolism, never through decoration.

Element	Direction
Look and feel	Generous white space, strong typography, restrained colour with one signature accent. Premium and quiet, never busy
Logo and symbol	Use the approved Sankofa mark. The symbol may be used subtly as a graphic device, such as a watermark or section marker
Typography	The approved brand typefaces, with an Ethiopic companion font for Amharic that matches in weight and tone
Photography	Real African boardrooms, directors and institutions photographed with dignity. Commissioned photography from Addis Ababa and Nairobi is preferred. No generic handshake stock images or safari clichés
Iconography	A simple, consistent line icon set for services and programmes
Motion	Minimal. Subtle transitions only; nothing that slows the page
Tone	Authoritative, measured, warm between peers. Plain English, short sentences

6. Functional Requirements

Bilingual content

- Full English and Amharic versions of every page, with a clear language switch in the header.
- Separate URLs for each language to support search.
- Right typographic handling of Ethiopic script, including line height and font fallbacks.
- Amharic translation to be done by a professional translator and reviewed by Shibeshi Bettemariam.

Event registration

- An event calendar and a page for each programme, managed by Sankofa staff through the content management system.
- An online registration form capturing name, title, organisation, email, phone, number of delegates and how the person heard about Sankofa.
- Automatic confirmation email and a notification to the Sankofa team.
- Invoice request option for corporate bookings, and online payment of deposits if a suitable payment gateway for Ethiopian and Kenyan clients can be integrated. Options to be proposed by the developer.
- Ability to close registration when an event is full and run a waiting list.

Forms and lead capture

- General enquiry form, consultancy enquiry form and directors body expression of interest form, each routed to the right partner.
- Newsletter signup linked to the chosen email marketing platform.
- Every form asks how the person heard about Sankofa, so marketing channels can be measured.

Content management

- An easy to use content management system, such as WordPress or a comparable platform, so the team can add events, articles and downloads without a developer.
- Training for two Sankofa users, with a short written guide.

Performance, access and security

- Mobile first design. Many directors will view the site on a phone.
- Fast loading on slower connections, with optimised images and a target load time under three seconds.
- Accessibility to WCAG 2.1 AA standard.
- SSL security, spam protection on all forms, regular backups and security updates.
- Compliance with Kenya's Data Protection Act and Ethiopian data protection requirements, with a privacy notice and cookie consent.

Search and analytics

- Search optimisation of every page, including titles and meta descriptions, which are provided in Part B.
- Google Analytics or an equivalent, with goals set for registrations, enquiries and newsletter signups.
- LinkedIn Insight Tag to support sponsored campaigns.
- Open Graph tags so pages share well on LinkedIn, Telegram and Facebook.

7. Content and Assets

Item	Responsibility
English website copy	Provided in Part B of this document
Amharic translation	Professional translator, reviewed by Shibeshi Bettemariam
Logo, colours, typography and brand guidelines	Sankofa, from the approved visual identity

Item	Responsibility
Partner photographs and profile of Shibeshi Bettemariam	Sankofa
Commissioned photography	Sankofa to commission, developer to advise on specifications
Programme brochures in PDF	Sankofa, designed from the visual identity
Insight articles	Sankofa partners

8. Hosting, Domain and Maintenance

- Domain name to be confirmed by Sankofa. The developer should check availability of suitable options.
- Reliable hosting with good performance in East Africa, and a content delivery network.
- Professional email on the domain for all partners.
- A maintenance and support agreement for 12 months after launch, covering updates, backups, security and minor changes.

9. Deliverables

- Design concepts for the home page and one inner page, followed by full page designs
- A fully built, bilingual, responsive website with all pages in the site map
- Event registration and all forms working and tested
- Content management system with trained users and a user guide
- Search, analytics and tracking set up
- Launch support and a 12 month maintenance agreement

10. Timeline

When	Milestone
By 21 October 2026	Visual identity approved; developer appointed; brief confirmed
Week of 26 October 2026	Design concepts presented
Week of 2 November 2026	Designs approved; build begins; Amharic translation starts
Week of 16 November 2026	Site on test server for review; content loaded
Week of 23 November 2026	Fixes, testing on mobile and in both languages
By 30 November 2026	Launch, in time to support the first training event campaign

11. Proposals and Approval

Developers are invited to submit a proposal including their approach, relevant examples of bilingual or institutional websites, the recommended platform, payment gateway options, a timeline, and a fixed price with maintenance costs. The website budget will be set in line with the financials agreed by the Sankofa board.

Final approval rests with the partners: Alvas Onguru and Duncan Watta in Nairobi, and Shibeshi Bettemariam in Addis Ababa.

Contact

Alvas Onguru | alvas@onguru.africa | +254 720 304 147

PART B: WEBSITE CONTENT

The English copy for every page follows. Labels in capitals show where each piece of copy sits on the page. Text in square brackets shows buttons or content still to be supplied.

Home

SEO element	Copy
Page title	Sankofa Consulting Board Governance Advisory and Training, Ethiopia
Meta description	Sankofa helps Ethiopian boards, regulators and state enterprises build strong governance, drawing on Kenya's experience of privatisation and listing.

HERO HEADLINE

Wisdom carried forward.

HERO SUBHEADLINE

Sankofa helps Ethiopia's boards and institutions build the governance they need for a new era of ownership, drawing on lessons already learned across Africa.

[Explore our programmes]

[Talk to us about your board]

SECTION: THE MOMENT

Ethiopia's boards are entering a new era.

State corporations are being opened to new owners through the Ethiopian Securities Exchange. Boards that once answered only to the state must now meet the standards of listed companies: sharper oversight, fuller disclosure and greater accountability to shareholders.

Kenya went through this change during its own privatisation and listing waves. We were in its boardrooms and its governance institutions. Sankofa exists to carry those lessons across, so Ethiopia can move faster and avoid mistakes others have already made.

SECTION: WHAT WE DO

Governance support at every level.

Service	Short description
Governance Frameworks and Policy	We help regulators, exchanges and ministries develop codes of corporate governance and governance legislation.
Executive Training	Focused programmes that build the skills directors need, in Addis Ababa and through immersion visits to Nairobi.
Board Consultancy	Multi year partnerships that strengthen individual boards, milestone by milestone.
Shareholder and Ownership Advisory	Guidance for owners and shareholders navigating the move from state to listed ownership.
Institution Building	Support for a national directors membership body to raise and sustain standards.

[See all services]

SECTION: UPCOMING PROGRAMMES

Learn from those who have been there.

Programme	When
Introduction to Corporate Governance	Q4 2026 [date to be confirmed]
Brand Governance	Q1 2027
Audit for Boards	Q2 2027
The Great Chairman	Q3 2027
Technology Governance	Q3 2027

[\[View the programme calendar \]](#)

SECTION: WHY SANKOFA

Experience you can build on.

- **Lived boardroom experience.** Our partners have led Kenya's own institute of directors, sat on boards and advised them for decades.
- **A true partnership.** Sankofa is built by Ethiopian and Kenyan partners as equals, with deep knowledge of both markets.
- **Practical, not theoretical.** Every programme and engagement is built around real cases and real board decisions.
- **Built to last.** We measure success by governance gains that endure long after our work is done.

SECTION: THE NAME

Sankofa is an Akan word from Ghana meaning "go back and get it." It teaches that there is wisdom in returning to what has been learned in order to build a better future. That is exactly what good governance does, and exactly what we do.

[\[Read our story \]](#)

NEWSLETTER BAND

The Sankofa Governance Briefing

A short monthly briefing on governance in Ethiopia and across Africa, with news of upcoming programmes. No clutter. Unsubscribe at any time.

[\[Subscribe \]](#)

About

SEO element	Copy
Page title	About Sankofa Consulting Our Story, Partners and Values
Meta description	Sankofa is a governance partnership between Addis Ababa and Nairobi, led by experienced board leaders. Learn about our story, our people and our values.

PAGE HEADLINE

Go back and get it.

INTRODUCTION

Sankofa Consulting is a board governance advisory, training and consultancy firm founded by partners in Addis Ababa and Nairobi. We work with regulators, state enterprises, listed companies and individual directors to build governance that earns trust and creates lasting value.

SECTION: THE MEANING OF SANKOFA

An ancient idea for a modern boardroom.

Sankofa is an ancient concept and Adinkra symbol of the Akan people of Ghana. In the Twi language, san means to return and kofa means to fetch or take. Together they mean "go back and get it." The philosophy is simple: it is not wrong to go back for the knowledge, wisdom and heritage of the past in order to build a better future.

The symbol is often drawn as a bird with its feet planted firmly forward and its head turned back to take a precious egg from its back. The forward feet stand for progress. The backward glance stands for memory and respect for roots. The egg stands for future generations and the knowledge carried forward to them.

We see every well governed board in that bird. It learns from what has gone before, moves confidently forward, and protects what it will pass on.

SECTION: OUR STORY

Built on a transition we have lived through.

Over two decades, Kenya built the codes, institutions and board practices needed to govern privatised and listed companies. The journey was not always smooth, and much was learned along the way.

Ethiopia now stands at a similar point, with the added advantage of being able to learn from others. Sankofa was founded to make that possible: an equal partnership of Ethiopian and Kenyan governance practitioners, combining local knowledge and relationships with proven experience of what works.

SECTION: OUR PARTNERS

Alvas Onguru, Partner, Nairobi. Alvas is a strategic communications and brand consultant with three decades of experience across leading agency networks in Africa, including McCann, DDB, Ogilvy and TBWA. He served on the Board of the Institute of Directors Kenya from 2019 to 2025, where he chaired the Membership, Strategy and Publicity Committee. He co-developed and co-facilitates Brand Strategy for Board Directors with the Centre for Corporate Governance, and holds an MBA in Creative Leadership from the Berlin School of Creative Leadership.

Duncan Watta, Partner, Nairobi. Duncan is a former Chairman of the Board of the Institute of Directors Kenya, where he also chaired the Strategy and Nominations Committees. He sits on a special committee of the Africa Corporate Governance Network mandated to help establish corporate governance institutions in countries that do not yet have them, and on its ESG Technical Committee. His executive career spans strategy, finance, supply chain and technology in telecoms, construction, tobacco and consumer goods across Africa, the UK, Western Europe and Mexico.

Gebrehawariat Shibeshi Bettemariam, Partner, Addis Ababa. [Profile to be supplied by Shibeshi Bettemariam.]

SECTION: OUR VALUES

- **Integrity.** We model the governance we teach.
- **Experience before theory.** Our advice comes from lived boardroom practice.
- **Partnership.** Ethiopian and Kenyan partners stand as equals.
- **Discretion.** Boards trust us with sensitive matters, and we protect that trust.
- **Lasting impact.** We measure success by governance gains that endure.

SECTION: VISION AND MISSION

Our vision. Well governed African institutions that create lasting value for their owners, their people and their nations.

Our mission. To strengthen the boards, codes and governance institutions of Ethiopia and the wider region through practical training, trusted advice and experience drawn from those who have been through the same transition.

[Talk to a partner]

Services

SEO element	Copy
Page title	Governance Services Sankofa Consulting
Meta description	Codes of corporate governance, executive training, board consultancy, shareholder advisory and institution building for Ethiopian boards and institutions.

PAGE HEADLINE

Governance support at every level.

INTRODUCTION

Strong governance needs good rules, capable boards, skilled directors and institutions that sustain standards over time. Sankofa works at every one of these levels.

Governance Frameworks and Policy Advisory

Setting the standards a market can grow on.

We work with securities exchanges, regulators and government ministries to develop the frameworks that shape how companies are governed. We bring direct experience of how codes are designed, consulted on and applied in practice, and we help make sure new standards fit Ethiopia's realities.

- Codes of corporate governance for listed companies
- Governance codes for state owned enterprises
- Governance and ethics legislation and regulations
- Compliance and reporting frameworks
- Training for regulators, officials and boards on new standards

[\[Discuss a policy engagement \]](#)

Executive Training

Skills for the modern boardroom.

Our programmes give directors the knowledge and confidence to govern well. Each is practical, discussion led and grounded in Ethiopian and Kenyan cases. Programmes run in Addis Ababa, as in house sessions for individual boards, or as Nairobi immersion programmes that combine training with visits to Kenyan organisations and a cultural experience.

- Introduction to Corporate Governance
- Brand Governance
- Audit for Boards
- The Great Chairman
- Technology Governance

[\[View programmes \]](#)

Board Consultancy

Stronger boards, milestone by milestone.

We partner with individual boards over one to two years to raise their effectiveness in lasting ways. Each engagement begins with an honest diagnosis and follows a clear plan with agreed milestones.

- Board evaluations and governance diagnostics

- Board charters, committee structures and terms of reference
- Governance policies and board calendars
- Board development plans
- Ongoing advice to chairs and company secretaries

[Talk to us about your board]

Shareholder and Ownership Advisory

Guiding owners through change.

The move from state to listed ownership changes the relationship between a company, its board and its owners. We help shareholders and ownership groups understand their rights and responsibilities and align their stakeholders.

- Shareholder education
- Ownership transition guidance
- Stakeholder and investor alignment
- Advice on the owner's role in board appointments and oversight

[Discuss ownership advisory]

Institution Building

Institutions that outlast any single project.

Lasting governance standards need a professional home. Our partners have led Kenya's institute of directors and currently help establish governance institutions across Africa. We support the creation of a national directors membership body for Ethiopia.

- Founding charters and governance structures
- Membership models and codes of conduct
- Professional development frameworks
- Registration and financing plans

[Learn about the directors body]

Programmes and Events

SEO element	Copy
Page title	Board and Director Training Programmes Sankofa Consulting
Meta description	Practical governance programmes for Ethiopian directors: corporate governance, brand, audit, chairmanship and technology governance. See dates and register.

PAGE HEADLINE

Learn from those who have been there.

INTRODUCTION

Our programmes are designed for busy directors. They are short, practical and built around real decisions that boards face. Every participant leaves with tools they can use at their next board meeting.

FORMATS

Format	Description
Open programmes in Addis Ababa	Directors from different organisations learn together and share perspectives across sectors
In house board sessions	Tailored sessions for a full board or committee, held at your premises
Nairobi immersion programmes	Several days in Kenya combining training, exchange visits to Kenyan organisations with lived experience, and a Kenyan cultural experience

Introduction to Corporate Governance

When: Q4 2026 [date to be confirmed] **Format and fee:** [to be confirmed]

The foundation for every director. This programme covers what boards are for, the duties directors owe, and what changes when a company moves from state to listed ownership.

You will learn to:

- Understand the role, duties and liabilities of a director
- Distinguish the work of the board from the work of management
- Apply the core principles of good governance to your own board
- Prepare for the expectations of listing, disclosure and shareholder accountability

Who should attend: New and serving directors, especially of companies preparing to list or recently divested.

[\[Register \]](#)

[\[Download the brochure \]](#)

Brand Governance

When: Q1 2027 **Format and fee:** [to be confirmed]

A company's reputation is one of its most valuable assets, yet few boards oversee it. Based on the Brand Strategy for Board Directors programme, this course treats brand as a governance matter.

You will learn to:

- See brand as a strategic asset that requires board oversight
- Ask management the right questions about brand strategy
- Read brand health indicators and oversee reputational risk
- Guide the board through a brand crisis

Who should attend: Directors, chairs and executives who report to the board on strategy and reputation.

[\[Register \]](#)

[\[Download the brochure \]](#)

Audit for Boards

When: Q2 2027 **Format and fee:** [to be confirmed]

Financial oversight is at the heart of the board's duty to shareholders. This programme builds confidence in overseeing audit, risk and financial reporting.

You will learn to:

- Understand the role and composition of an effective audit committee
- Oversee internal and external audit
- Interpret financial statements and key risk indicators
- Strengthen internal controls and risk management

Who should attend: Audit and risk committee members, chairs and directors without a financial background.

[\[Register \]](#)

[\[Download the brochure \]](#)

The Great Chairman

When: Q3 2027 **Format and fee:** [to be confirmed]

The chair sets the tone for the whole board. This programme explores what great board leadership looks like in practice.

You will learn to:

- Lead effective, focused board meetings
- Build a strong, balanced relationship with the CEO
- Manage board dynamics, dissent and difficult conversations
- Lead board evaluation and succession planning

Who should attend: Current and aspiring chairs and committee chairs.

[\[Register \]](#)

[\[Download the brochure \]](#)

Technology Governance

When: Q3 2027 **Format and fee:** [to be confirmed]

Technology now shapes strategy, risk and value in every sector. This programme equips boards to oversee it with confidence.

You will learn to:

- Oversee technology strategy and major digital investments
- Understand and govern cyber security and data risk

- Ask the right questions about artificial intelligence
- Build technology expertise into board composition

Who should attend: All directors, particularly those on risk, audit and strategy committees.

[Register]

[Download the brochure]

CLOSING BAND

Looking for a programme for your whole board? We design in house sessions around your board's priorities.

[Enquire about in house training]

Insights

SEO element	Copy
Page title	Governance Insights Sankofa Consulting
Meta description	Articles and briefing papers on corporate governance in Ethiopia and Africa: ownership transition, board practice, codes and directors.

PAGE HEADLINE

Insights for the boardroom.

INTRODUCTION

Short, practical perspectives on the governance questions facing Ethiopian boards today, from our partners and guest contributors.

TOPIC FILTERS

Ownership Transition | Board Practice | Codes and Regulation | Brand and Reputation | Audit and Risk | Technology | Directors

LAUNCH ARTICLES: TITLES AND SUMMARIES

What Ethiopia's boards can learn from Kenya's privatisation journey

Kenya's listing waves transformed its boardrooms, sometimes painfully. We look at five lessons Ethiopian boards can apply now.

[\[Read more \]](#)

From state to shareholder: what changes in the boardroom

When a state corporation lists, the board's obligations change overnight. A practical guide to what directors must do differently.

[\[Read more \]](#)

Why Ethiopia needs a national institute of directors

Codes set standards, but professional bodies sustain them. The case for a directors membership body, and what it would do.

[\[Read more \]](#)

Directors Body

SEO element	Copy
Page title	A Directors Membership Body for Ethiopia Sankofa Consulting
Meta description	Help establish Ethiopia's national directors membership body. Learn about the initiative and register your interest as a founding member.

PAGE HEADLINE

A professional home for Ethiopia's directors.

INTRODUCTION

Many countries have a national institute of directors: a professional body that sets standards, develops directors and speaks for good governance. Ethiopia does not yet have one. As its corporations move to new ownership, the need has never been greater.

SECTION: WHY IT MATTERS

- It sets professional standards and a code of conduct for directors
- It offers continuing development and recognised qualifications
- It connects directors across sectors to share experience
- It gives directors a trusted voice in shaping governance policy

SECTION: OUR ROLE

Sankofa's partners bring direct experience of building and leading such an institution. Our Kenyan partners served on the Board of the Institute of Directors Kenya, one as its Chairman. Duncan Watta also sits on an Africa Corporate Governance Network committee mandated to help establish governance institutions across the continent. We are working with respected Ethiopian directors to form a founding group and draft a founding charter.

SECTION: HOW IT WILL COME TOGETHER

Stage	What happens
1. Founding group	Respected Ethiopian directors come together to lead the initiative
2. Charter	The founding group agrees the body's purpose, membership, governance and code of conduct
3. Registration	The body is formally registered in Ethiopia
4. Launch	Membership opens to directors across Ethiopia

CALL TO ACTION

Be part of it from the start.

If you are a serving director and would like to help shape this institution, or to be informed when membership opens, register your interest.

[[Register your interest](#)]

Contact

SEO element	Copy
Page title	Contact Sankofa Consulting Addis Ababa and Nairobi
Meta description	Contact Sankofa Consulting in Addis Ababa or Nairobi about governance training, board consultancy and advisory services.

PAGE HEADLINE

Let's talk about your board.

INTRODUCTION

Whether you want to register for a programme, discuss a board engagement or learn more about our work, we would be glad to hear from you. We respond to every enquiry within two working days.

CONTACT DETAILS

Office	Details
Addis Ababa	Shibeshi Bettemariam, Partner House Number 3831, Wereda 13 Bole Sub City, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia [Phone and email to be supplied]
Nairobi	Alvas Onguru, Partner alvas@onguru.africa +254 720 304 147

ENQUIRY FORM FIELDS

Name | Title | Organisation | Email | Phone | I am interested in: Training, Board consultancy, Policy and frameworks, Shareholder advisory, Directors body, Other | Message | How did you hear about Sankofa?

[[Send enquiry](#)]

FORM CONFIRMATION MESSAGE

Thank you for contacting Sankofa Consulting. A partner will be in touch within two working days.

Global Footer

Sankofa Consulting Limited. Board governance advisory, training and consultancy. Addis Ababa and Nairobi.

alvas@onguru.africa | +254 720 304 147 | [LinkedIn](#)

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